

# Bio 152 | Spring 2025

## Independent Project Second Draft Self-evaluation

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In reflecting on your Second Draft, first consider the guiding questions below. Then under each section listed provide a few sentences pertaining to that element, with an honest evaluation of how you are feeling about that aspect of your work. You do not have to answer each question individually. They are just prompts to help guide your reflection.

Final paper grades will be based on the clarity, logic, and depth of your work. This self-evaluation is meant to help you think through where you should focus your efforts in the next submission. This worksheet also gives your IP reviewer insight into your own thinking so they know better how to help guide you to successful project completion.

### 1. TITLE AND ABSTRACT

- a. Does the title reflect your study's purpose?
- b. Does the title reflect your preliminary results or interpretation of them?
- c. Do you summarize your investigation in a brief paragraph Abstract (~120 words)?
- d. In your abstract, if applicable, is it clear that this is based on preliminary research?
- e. In your abstract, do you include your purpose, rationale, brief design (methods), results, and conclusions?

*Which of the criteria listed above went very well, and what parts do you think you could use some help with? Providing specifics will help you and your reviewer. Add space as you need to.*

- a. Yes, but I would like to change it slightly to be a bit more theatrical
- b. Yes
- c. Yes
- d. Yes
- e. Yes

### 2. INTRODUCTION

- a. Is there a clear statement of purpose for the research?
- b. Is the biological rationale for the research clearly stated and logically connected with an explanation of the biological mechanisms involved? Is background information from the literature presented to support this rationale?
- c. Is the broader justification for the study (impact to science and humanity) clearly stated and logically connected? Is background information from the literature presented to support this justification?
- d. Is your testable hypothesis clearly stated?

*Which of the criteria listed above went very well, and what parts do you think you could use some help with? Providing specifics will help you and your reviewer. Add space as you need to.*

- a. Yes
- b. Yes
- c. Yes
- d. Yes, I think perhaps this could be worked on or refined depending on what we remove from our paper to meet the word count

### 3. METHODS

- a. Do your methods test your stated hypothesis?
- b. Do you outline how you will collect or did collect the data? When appropriate, is there an explanation of how others collected and compiled your data?
- c. Is there a clear description of and justification for the methods used to analyze the data?
- d. Is your description specific enough that a reader can understand exactly what you plan to do or did and replicate it?

*Which of the criteria listed above went very well, and what parts do you think you could use some help with? Providing specifics will help you and your reviewer. Add space as you need to.*

- a. Yes
- b. Yes
- c. Yes
- d. Yes

### 4. RESULTS

- a. Are your data summarized or statistically analyzed properly and appropriately?
- b. Are your data also represented visually (e.g., in tables and/or figures) for easier comprehension?
- c. Do the visual representations help the reader understand the analyses and results?
- d. Are the legends descriptive enough that anyone can understand the table/figure without reading the text of the paper?
- e. Are the visual depictions of data and/or analyses referred to in the text?
- f. Based on methods used and results obtained, are your conclusions about the data reasonable?

*Which of the criteria listed above went very well, and what parts do you think you could use some help with? Providing specifics will help you and your reviewer. Add space as you need to.*

- a. Yes
- b. Yes
- c. Yes
- d. Yes, but I believe they are too verbose at times and could be shortened
- e. Yes
- f. yes

### 5. DISCUSSION

- a. Are your results interpreted in context of your hypothesis/es?
- b. Are your conclusions explained in the context of biology?
- c. Do you describe any sources of error or limitations?
- d. Do you propose any related areas for related future research?
- e. Is the connection to the overall purpose of the research and broader implications of the results clear?

*Which of the criteria listed above went very well, and what parts do you think you could use some help with? Providing specifics will help you and your reviewer. Add space as you need to.*

- a. Yes
- b. No, can add more discussion for the final draft
- c. Yes we attempt to explore every avenue of error
- d. Yes as we bring up any limitation we talk about future research
- e. Yes but could be stronger

## 6. REFERENCES

- a. Do you cite any sources you've used throughout all sections of your paper?
- b. Are all non-original claims supported by literature?
- c. Are the references cited correctly?

*Which of the criteria listed above went very well, and what parts do you think you could use some help with? Providing specifics will help you and your reviewer. Add space as you need to.*

- a. Yes we do and we changed it to APA styling
- b. As far as I know yes
- c. Hopefully

## 7. OVERALL WRITING QUALITY

- a. Is the Second Draft well organized?
- b. Does it flow logically?
- c. Do you use transitions when appropriate (e.g. between sections to help tie them together)?
- d. Do you use proper punctuation, grammar, and spelling?
- e. Do you use the same tense throughout the paper?
- f. Is the paper clear, concise, and readable?

*Which of the criteria listed above went very well, and what parts do you think you could use some help with? Providing specifics will help you and your reviewer. Add space as you need to.*

- a. Yes
- b. Yes
- c. Yes
- d. Yes
- e. Unsure and a massive checkthrough will happen before our final draft
- f. It is too long currently

## 8. LEARNING PROCESS & RESOURCE USE

- a. What aspects of your project do you understand better after completing the Second Draft?
- b. What do you hope to understand better before submitting your Final Paper? Are there things you plan to change about your approach to writing for the last submission?

- c. Did you use any AI resources to gather information, find data, brainstorm topics, or help with other pre-writing tasks? (*You will not be penalized for using AI in this manner. Remember, AI may not be used to write any aspect of your IP submissions*).
- a. How are structure will look for the final draft
  - b. There is nothing drastic in our style that we are going to change but we will need to cut down information
  - c. No

**Lastly, if you had to grade your paper on a scale of 1 to 5, how would you score it? Use the criteria below.**

SCORE:   4  

- Poor = 1
  - This paper has fundamental flaws. It might be hard to understand, be completely off topic, or be missing essential components. While some of the required elements might be present in the draft, none of them were successful.
- Fair = 2
  - This submission has some substantial issues. There might be the beginnings of good elements, but they are far from complete or clear.
- Good = 3
  - This submission is on the right track but might be lacking detail and/or content depth. It might take some effort to understand the study and biological rationales for the project.
- Very good = 4
  - The paper is successful in conveying information clearly and there is logical flow throughout the paper. There are still some small improvements to be made, but it is in very good shape at this stage.
- Excellent = 5
  - All the elements are executed extremely well. The content is easy to understand, and its importance is clear. Any suggested changes are purely a matter of reader preference and don't impact clarity.